

INTERNATIONAL LANGUAGES

OVERVIEW

In courses in international languages, students develop their listening, speaking, reading, and writing skills in order to communicate in the language of study (the target language) in a variety of contexts and for a variety of purposes, with a focus on real-life situations and uses. Through their exploration of a wide variety of authentic materials and meaningful activities, students develop not only language skills but also the skills necessary for lifelong language learning. They also acquire an understanding and appreciation of diverse communities around the world where the target language is spoken, and make connections to their own community.

Language structures and conventions that are appropriate for each level are listed in the Language Knowledge chart for international languages that is provided in Appendix B. Students should be given ample opportunities to demonstrate and extend their understanding of the language elements by applying them in a wide variety of contexts across the strands. Two additional charts are provided to assist teachers in planning learning activities – Topics for Developing Vocabulary, and Cultural Concepts for Developing Intercultural Understanding.

The expectations for courses in international languages are organized into four distinct but related strands:

Listening

Oral communication skills lay the foundation for the acquisition of any new language, and pave the way for learning to read and write in that language. Well-developed listening skills are essential for students' development of the proficiency in the target language that they will need to succeed in the program. To develop their listening and interaction skills, international language learners need extensive opportunities to listen to and interact with others. They also need to develop listening skills in order to understand what is said during classroom presentations, in radio and television broadcasts, and in many other contexts. At first, students listen to directions and instructions; as they progress, they are able to take point-form notes in class; and eventually, they are able to provide a summary of a presentation.

International language learners need many opportunities to listen to a range of subjects, including topics that interest them, concepts in school subjects, and contemporary issues. Students listen to words, phrases, and passages in the target language in order to identify standard pronunciation and to improve their reading comprehension. Students listen to explanations of language structures and conventions and cultural concepts. They also

listen to a wide range of oral texts representing formal and informal social registers and various genres and forms appropriate to their interests (e.g., podcasts, videos, song lyrics, radio shows, electronic sources, poetry, short stories, advertisements, video games, radio shows). They also need exposure to oral texts of increasing difficulty in the target language, such as longer radio broadcasts or documentaries on more complex topics.

It is important that teachers contextualize listening interactions and activities for students. This can be done through brainstorming to identify what students already know about the topic of a new text they are about to hear or view. Some examples of richly integrated tasks are: discussing strategies for organizing ideas for a writing assignment; presenting and defending ideas or debating current issues; and offering constructive and descriptive feedback about work produced by their peers.

Speaking

Oral language is a fundamental means of communicating with others and the cornerstone of learning in all areas. Students build a broad range of speaking skills, both for conversational purposes and for academic purposes, such as presenting ideas and information to their classmates. At first, students engage in brief conversations on everyday topics; as they progress, they engage in speaking tasks such as sharing ideas about a variety of texts in a literature circle; and eventually, they are able to present classroom seminars or participate in debates.

International language learners need rich and frequent opportunities to speak and interact in the classroom in a purposeful way – for example, through collaborative learning in pairs and small groups that allows them to engage in speaking and listening for real-life purposes. Through multiple opportunities to speak in various groupings, students begin to communicate effectively and to gain confidence as they explore ideas and concepts, identify and solve problems, organize information, and express and clarify their thoughts, feelings, and opinions. An opportunity for self-reflection about their speaking skills and strategies enables students to strengthen their ability to express themselves and interact with other speakers of the target language.

It is important that teachers not only offer instruction and feedback, but also provide excellent models of the competence that a first-language speaker would demonstrate in speaking for both academic and social purposes. Teachers at all course levels should also provide modelling of various special sound features of the international language, and include instruction on norms and conventions associated with speaking the language in different cultures.

Reading

This strand provides extensive opportunities for students to build on their experience in listening to and speaking the target language to help them determine the meaning of written texts in the target language. Students read a wide variety of adapted and authentic literary, informational, and graphic texts from diverse cultures and for a variety of purposes. They activate their background knowledge, acquire vocabulary, think aloud about what they are reading, discuss texts with peers, and participate in group reading and learning activities. An effective reader not only grasps the ideas communicated in a text but is able to apply them in new contexts. To do this, the student must be able to think clearly, creatively, and critically about the ideas and information encountered in texts. The student can then understand, analyse, and absorb them and recognize their relevance in other contexts. The international languages curriculum develops the knowledge, strategies, and skills that will enable students to become effective readers in the target language.

As learners develop their reading skills in the target language, it is important that they have many opportunities to read a wide variety of texts from diverse cultures and for a variety of purposes. By reading widely, students will develop a richer vocabulary, become more attuned to the language structures and conventions of the target language in various genres, and increase their understanding of diverse world views.

Reading is a complex process that provides a bridge between speaking and writing. Students learning to read in the target language are also acquiring knowledge of new vocabulary and language structures, as well as a new phonological awareness of the sound system of the target language. Reading also involves the application of many comprehension strategies before, during, and after reading. Teachers need to model the use of such strategies, engage students in shared and guided exploration of texts, and foster the independent application of reading strategies. Students need to identify which strategies are personally most helpful and how they can use these and other strategies to improve as readers. For example, students might prepare before reading by identifying the purpose of the reading activity and by activating their prior knowledge about the topic of the text and the vocabulary contained in that text.

During reading, students may use clues from context or from their understanding of language elements and structures to help them determine the meaning of unfamiliar words. They will also use a variety of comprehension strategies such as predicting, questioning, identifying main ideas, and monitoring comprehension to help them understand a text. After reading, students may analyse, synthesize, make connections, evaluate, and use other critical and creative thinking skills to achieve a deeper understanding of the material they have read. For example, students might evaluate an author's perspective or bias in a piece of writing and discuss how that might affect the reader's interpretation.

To become fluent readers of the target language, students need to read frequently and develop the range of skills required to read for a variety of different purposes – to follow directions, to get advice, to obtain information, to build vocabulary, to obtain access to subject knowledge, and for personal interest and enjoyment.

It is important that students read a range of authentic materials illustrating the many uses of writing, since these texts will serve as models for texts that they will create. The reading program should therefore include a wide variety of literary, informational, fictional, and graphic texts – for example, short story, myth, legend, folk tale, poem, song, novel, play, report, newspaper or magazine article, television or radio script, manual, advertisements, autobiography, chart, diagram, graphic novel, comic book, recipes, and instructions.

Writing

From their experience with oral communication and reading, students acquire the skills they need to become good writers who are able to communicate ideas and opinions with ease and clarity. Current research confirms the similarity in the writing processes of both first- and second- language writers. The elements that go into writing in any language are essentially similar: selecting a topic; organizing and developing ideas to be included; choosing the form of writing and level of language appropriate to the audience and the purpose for writing; applying the conventions of written language such as grammar, spelling, punctuation, and word choice; and applying editing, revising, and proofreading strategies to produce a polished piece of writing.

However, for students who are learning a second language, the planning stage of the writing process is critical. Students must become skilled at choosing the correct vocabulary in the target language,

while selecting and organizing their ideas. They must also keep in mind the purpose for which they are writing and the audience they are addressing. To communicate clearly and effectively, they need to learn to use standard written forms and the language conventions of the target language.

Students who are beginning to write in the target language need to read a wide variety of texts that expose them to uses of vocabulary, grammatical elements, and idioms that they will need when writing their own texts. As students read a variety of written texts, they not only increase their vocabulary but also learn to vary their sentence structure, their organizational approach, and the voice they use in their writing. Students should produce a variety of forms or types of writing, such as descriptions, letters, journal entries, advertisements, brochures, summaries, reviews, dialogues, poems, short stories, questionnaires, newspaper articles, essays, and reports. Students should be given opportunities to produce interactive writing, different types of creative writing, as well as writing that addresses topics of interest to them and reflects their capacity for independent critical thought. Writing activities that are seen by students as meaningful and that challenge them to think critically and creatively will help them achieve a fuller and more lasting command of the essential skills of writing. Students' writing activities, in turn, support and reinforce both their oral language skills and their reading skills.

In addition, all students, whether they are writing in their first language or any other language, need to be taught ways to avoid plagiarism when writing for reporting and research purposes.

For more information about effective instruction in the four strands, consult the ministry resource document entitled *Adolescent Literacy Guide: A Professional Learning Resource for Literacy, Grades 7–12, 2013*.

International Languages, Level 1

Open

LBABO – LDYBO

This course provides opportunities for students to begin to develop and apply fundamental skills in listening, speaking, reading, and writing in the language of study. Students will communicate and interact in structured activities and practical situations, with a focus on matters of personal interest and familiar topics, and will read and write simple texts in the language. Throughout the course, students will acquire a general understanding and appreciation of diverse communities in regions of the world where the language is spoken. They will also develop skills necessary for lifelong language learning.

Prerequisite: None

A. LISTENING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. Listening to Understand:** determine meaning in a variety of oral texts in the target language, using a range of listening strategies;
- A2. Listening to Interact:** interpret messages accurately while interacting in the target language for a variety of purposes and with diverse audiences;
- A3. Intercultural Understanding:** demonstrate an understanding of information in oral texts in the target language about aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language used in a variety of situations and communities.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Listening to Understand

By the end of this course, students will:

A1.1 Using Listening Comprehension

Strategies: identify a range of listening comprehension strategies and use them before, during, and after listening to understand basic oral texts in the target language (e.g., *brainstorm about the topic before a listening task to make connections to prior knowledge and personal experiences; preview a vocabulary list to predict the topic of an announcement; use visual and non-verbal auditory cues, such as the speaker's body language and tone of voice, to aid comprehension; sketch while listening to help them recall the information later; listen to a text multiple times to monitor and clarify comprehension; ask for clarification after listening to a text*)

Teacher prompts: “Judging by this vocabulary list, what do you think the announcement will be about?” “Watch and listen to the speaker carefully. What visual and non-verbal auditory cues help you understand the message?”

- A1.2 Demonstrating Understanding:** demonstrate an understanding of the purpose and meaning of oral texts in the target language that contain information about matters of personal interest and familiar topics, with contextual and visual support (e.g., *produce a drawing based on an oral description of familiar objects; identify the message of a recorded announcement or audio*

webcast; identify vocabulary related to cuisine while viewing a target-language cooking show; identify vocabulary related to time, days, months, and numbers in a peer's presentation about a vacation, and classify it using a graphic organizer; identify familiar words and expressions in a popular target-language song; create a collage to illustrate the message of a radio commercial; summarize key information in a peer's oral presentation about a hobby, using words, pictures, or actions; classify food items by type and/or price after listening to a description)

Teacher prompts: “What elements of the objects were included in the description? Make sure you include them in your drawing.” “What images or symbols might you use in your collage to explain the message you heard?”

A2. Listening to Interact

By the end of this course, students will:

A2.1 Using Interactive Listening Strategies:

identify and use a range of interactive listening strategies to suit a variety of situations while participating in structured interactions in the target language (e.g., *use and respond to visual cues such as nodding and head shaking; lean forward during an interaction to signal interest; observe a peer's body language to help them interpret his or her intended message; ask their partner in an interaction to repeat his or her statement; use*

respectful body language to acknowledge the responses of another student in a think-pair-share activity; listen for a short silence at the end of another speaker's turn to avoid interrupting him or her)

Teacher prompts: “What are some examples of body language that can help you understand a peer’s intended message?” “What can you do if you are not certain you have understood an interaction?”

A2.2 Interacting: respond with understanding to what others say while participating in brief, structured interactions in the target language about themselves, family, friends, and their immediate environment, with contextual and visual support (e.g., in pairs and small groups, answer questions on topics of personal interest using actions and familiar words and expressions; express personal preferences when interviewed by a classmate; offer comparable information in response to a peer’s description of a family member or pet; agree or disagree with a partner verbally and non-verbally in a conversation about movies; after listening to a song, share reactions to the lyrics with a peer; negotiate with a partner about which items to include on a grocery list with a limited budget)

Teacher prompt: “In what ways do you and your classmate share similar opinions about movies? How do they differ?”

A2.3 Metacognition:

(a) describe some strategies they found helpful before, during, and after listening;
(b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as listeners, and plan steps they can take to improve their listening skills (e.g., plan to keep a list of helpful listening strategies for future reference; describe steps they can take to listen more actively during interactions; identify strategies that help them recall information after a conversation; identify and describe listening strategies that helped them contribute more effectively to a small-group discussion)

Teacher prompts: “What strategies do you currently use to listen actively? What might you change?” “What strategies do you use to recall important information after listening?”

A3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 Intercultural Awareness: using information from oral texts in the target language, identify communities where the target language is spoken, find out about aspects of their cultures, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (e.g., listen to a description of a traditional dish and identify key ingredients; on a map of Ontario, Canada, or the world, locate communities where the target language is spoken after listening to directions; identify where the target language can be heard in their own environment, such as on multicultural television programs or world music radio stations; listen to a description of a holiday or a cultural event in a target-language community and match it to a picture or to familiar vocabulary; in a popcorn activity, answer basic questions about information presented in a target-language play; while listening to a short text about a specific target-language community or region, draw or make jot notes about its distinctive features)

Teacher prompts: “Where on the map can you find communities in which the target language is spoken? How near or far are they from your own community?” “What words or pictures do you think best exemplify the holiday you have just heard about?”

A3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions:

using information from oral texts in the target language, identify and demonstrate an understanding of sociolinguistic conventions used in a variety of situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken (e.g., identify some of the speech conventions used in a telephone call; identify non-verbal cues used by target-language speakers in different social contexts, such as at a party or in a classroom; identify familiar expressions of greeting and farewell in a variety of oral texts; identify some conventions of polite speech in an exchange between a salesperson and a customer; after listening to a dialogue, identify some ways to express gratitude)

Teacher prompts: “How can differences in speakers’ non-verbal cues affect their message? Why is it important to be aware of how non-verbal cues are used in different contexts?” “What is an example of a target-language expression that conveys gratitude?”

B. SPEAKING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. Speaking to Communicate:** communicate information and ideas orally in the target language, using a range of speaking strategies, appropriate language structures, and level-appropriate language suited to the purpose and audience;
- B2. Speaking to Interact:** participate in spoken interactions in the target language for a variety of purposes and with diverse audiences;
- B3. Intercultural Understanding:** in their spoken communications in the target language, demonstrate an awareness of aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of the appropriate use of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language in a variety of situations.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Speaking to Communicate

By the end of this course, students will:

B1.1 Using Oral Communication Strategies:

identify a range of speaking strategies and use them to express themselves clearly and coherently in the target language for various purposes and to a variety of audiences (*e.g., use gestures and mime to clarify their meaning; refer to classroom visual aids such as a word wall or an anchor chart to retrieve vocabulary while speaking; adjust volume and tone of voice to suit the context; use a template to guide a retell; use modelled sentence starters and prompts when sharing information*)

Teacher prompts: “What examples can you give of how gestures or mime might clarify what you want to say?” “How does changing your volume and tone of voice affect your message?”

B1.2 Producing Oral Communications:

produce brief, rehearsed messages in the target language to communicate information about matters of personal interest and familiar topics, with contextual, auditory, and visual support (*e.g., introduce themselves or a classmate, using a teacher-generated template; describe how to find an object; deliver a presentation on a hobby or sport, using modelled sentence starters and prompts; ask questions using a variety of interrogative words; compose and deliver a school announcement about*

an environmental activity such as reducing waste; present a personal perspective on healthy food choices; describe some items they need to purchase at the beginning and/or end of the school year, noting their prices)

Teacher prompts: “As you give directions, think about the location of the object. What is the best route to get to it? What obstacles may be present?” “What kinds of information make an announcement useful? What can you add to your announcement to make sure your listeners will learn everything they need to know?”

B1.3 Speaking with Fluency: speak with a smooth pace, appropriate intonation, and standard pronunciation in brief, rehearsed communications in the target language about a variety of familiar topics (*e.g., accurately recite tongue twisters, chants, and rhymes modelled by the teacher, either individually or in choral speaking; deliver an oral report with appropriate phrasing and emphasis; accurately pronounce familiar vocabulary when describing their interests; use standard greetings and expressions of courtesy with ease*)

Teacher prompts: “When you practise chants and rhymes, what aspects of speaking should you focus on? What is the result?” “In what ways can you use your voice to ensure that your message is clear when delivering a report?”

B1.4 Applying Language Knowledge: use language structures and conventions appropriate for this course (see the Language Knowledge chart for international languages in Appendix B) to communicate their meaning clearly in the target language

B2. Speaking to Interact

By the end of this course, students will:

B2.1 Using Conversation Strategies: identify and use a range of conversation strategies to suit a variety of structured, guided, formal, and informal situations while participating in simple spoken interactions in the target language (*e.g., use body language to signal that they would like to add an opinion or ask a question during a group discussion; use non-verbal cues such as body language and eye contact to highlight important points in a conversation with a peer; look at the listener while speaking; incorporate expressions of courtesy when acknowledging the contributions of others during group work; make personal connections to the experiences of a partner when responding during a think-pair-share*)

Teacher prompt: “What facial expression might you use to emphasize that you are making a significant point? How would your expression differ if the point was positive or negative?”

B2.2 Interacting: engage in brief, structured spoken interactions in the target language about matters of personal interest and familiar topics, with teacher modelling and support (*e.g., offer and respond to greetings; ask and respond to simple questions about age, family, favourite school subjects, the weather, and holidays; contribute brief instructions in interactive games and structured oral activities; ask a peer about likes and dislikes; with a peer, role-play an exchange between a customer and a salesperson in a clothing shop; role-play bargaining for goods in a market or community fair*)

Teacher prompts: “What questions can you ask to maintain a conversation with a peer about likes and dislikes?” “You are the customer in a role play about shopping. What questions can you ask about an article of clothing that interests you?”

B2.3 Metacognition:

- (a) describe some strategies they found helpful before, during, and after speaking to communicate effectively;
- (b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as speakers, and plan steps they can take to improve their speaking skills (*e.g., plan to reflect on feedback from peers and the teacher*

on revising the content of their spoken messages; describe in a student-teacher conference how they self-monitor their speaking skills; discuss the effectiveness of incorporating non-verbal cues into speech; plan to set small, attainable goals to improve their oral communication and increase their confidence)

Teacher prompts: “What kinds of revisions do you plan to make to your speech? What kind of feedback was most helpful?” “What kinds of non-verbal cues do you use when speaking? How do they affect your listener?” “What goal might you set to improve your oral communication? Is it focused enough to achieve without problems?”

B3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 Intercultural Awareness: communicate information orally in the target language about communities where the target language is spoken, including aspects of their cultures and their contributions to the world, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (*e.g., describe the ingredients in and procedure for making a familiar regional dish; identify and report on when and where the target language is spoken in their immediate environment; dramatize a meal-time custom; describe a region or community where the target language is spoken, using a poster they have made or found to illustrate their remarks; sing or retell a target-language song or story; share with a peer information about a tradition or festival in a region where the target language is spoken, and make connections to a custom in their own community, such as a First Nations powwow; describe a popular eco-tourism destination in a region where the target language is spoken, using images to illustrate their remarks*)

Teacher prompts: “When and where have you noticed the target language being spoken in your own community?” “What similarities can you find between this festival and something you celebrate in your own community?”

B3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions: identify sociolinguistic conventions associated with a variety of social situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken, and use them appropriately in spoken interactions in the target language (*e.g., use standard phrases to introduce themselves and others; use the appropriate level of formality to address people in a personal or community setting; use contextually appropriate gestures and other*

forms of non-verbal communication, such as shaking hands or greeting someone with a kiss on the cheek or in the air; use conventional speech formulas to initiate and conclude conversations politely; use appropriate expressions to indicate understanding or lack of understanding)

Teacher prompts: “What are some common forms of non-verbal communication used by target-language speakers? When and where might you use them?” “How can you politely close a conversation?”

C. READING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Reading Comprehension:** determine meaning in a variety of texts in the target language, using a range of reading comprehension strategies;
- C2. Purpose, Form, and Style:** identify the purpose(s), characteristics, and aspects of style of a variety of adapted and authentic text forms, including fictional, informational, graphic, and media forms;
- C3. Intercultural Understanding:** demonstrate an understanding of information in texts in the target language about aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language used in a variety of situations and communities.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Reading Comprehension

By the end of this course, students will:

C1.1 Using Reading Comprehension

Strategies: identify a range of reading comprehension strategies and use them before, during, and after reading to understand simple texts in the target language, in modelled, shared, guided, and independent reading contexts (*e.g., refer to illustrations, photographs, diagrams, and/or the cover of a text to help them predict its message; make connections between personal experience and the overall message of a text to extend their understanding; ask questions to get additional information about the topic; highlight key words to help them determine the main idea*)

Teacher prompts: “What familiar words do you recognize in the text? How do they help you understand the message?” “What does the cover tell you about the topic?”

C1.2 Reading for Meaning: demonstrate an understanding of information and ideas in simple texts in the target language, with teacher support as appropriate (*e.g., outline the plot of a story read in class by drawing and labelling pictures; using props, dramatize ordering a meal based on information in a menu; share details from a pen pal’s letter with a peer; mime a procedure such as making a sandwich after reading instructions from a classmate; identify and record key information in an e-mailed reservation confirmation; plan a trip using information from a bus or train schedule*)

C1.3 Reading with Fluency: read texts in the target language that contain familiar vocabulary and expressions at a sufficient rate and with sufficient ease to demonstrate that they understand the overall sense of the text (*e.g., make reading aloud sound like speaking, pausing as indicated by the punctuation; smoothly articulate high-frequency words and familiar words while reading aloud; use appropriate phrasing when reading a poem aloud*)

Teacher prompt: “As you read this text aloud, imagine that the words are being spoken rather than read. Where would a speaker naturally pause, change his or her tone of voice, or get louder or softer?”

C1.4 Developing Vocabulary: use a range of vocabulary-acquisition strategies before, during, and after reading to determine or confirm the meaning of new, unfamiliar, or recently learned words (*e.g., consult a word wall to confirm or revise their interpretation of unfamiliar words, and keep a personal lexicon updated; construct a word web of vocabulary relating to a specific topic; create a bank of words encountered in non-fiction texts*)

Teacher prompt: “Describe some techniques for remembering new words or expressions you encounter when reading. Which one do you find most helpful?”

C2. Purpose, Form, and Style

By the end of this course, students will:

C2.1 Purposes and Characteristics of Text

Forms: identify the purpose(s) and characteristics of some familiar text forms, including fictional, informational, graphic, and media forms, and explain how the characteristics help communicate the meaning (*e.g., predictable structure in a pattern book makes the text accessible for new language learners; the division of information into short sections in a how-to book allows the reader to follow instructions easily; a list of components enables the consumer to check that a product is complete before assembly and/or use; pictures and product information in a catalogue give consumers information to help them make choices; images and short paragraphs on a website encourage the user to browse instead of reading in depth*)

Teacher prompts: “How does the format of a pattern book help new learners of a language understand the message?” “What is the purpose of including pictures in a catalogue?”

C2.2 Text Features and Elements of Style:

identify some features and stylistic elements of familiar text forms, including fictional, informational, graphic, and media forms, and explain how they help convey the meaning (*e.g., rhyme and repetition emphasize particular ideas in a poem; numbered steps and diagrams in a manual guide the user through procedures; a price column and subsections by course allow the diner to skim a menu for information; graphics, fonts, colours, and illustrations in an advertisement highlight the features of the product; titles and subtitles organize information in an article or a report; maps and sample itineraries in a travel guide help the reader plan the details of a trip*)

Teacher prompts: “How is the text laid out in this manual? Why?” “What are some elements of a travel guide that help readers find the information they need to plan a trip?”

C2.3 Metacognition:

(a) describe some strategies they found helpful before, during, and after reading to understand texts;
(b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as readers, and plan steps they can take to improve their reading skills (*e.g., plan to preview vocabulary to improve reading fluency; identify which strategies they use regularly and automatically and which they seldom use, and decide whether to revise their practice; plan to reread to find information they may have overlooked; reflect on their use of reading comprehension strategies and plan to use the ones they find most effective when setting new goals; with a peer,*

exchange helpful strategies, and plan to try one used by their classmate)

Teacher prompts: “Can you identify a strategy that you use frequently and automatically? Do you think it is effective? What might you change about your practice?” “What strategy do you use to remember important points? How does it compare to the strategy that your classmate uses?”

C3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 Intercultural Awareness: using information from a variety of texts in the target language, identify communities where the target language is spoken, find out about aspects of their cultures, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (*e.g., locate target-language communities in an atlas or a geographical database; order from an authentic menu according to a budget; determine the ingredients in a recipe from a target-language community; identify and describe a theme or character in a legend from a target-language community; identify cultural events listed in an online newspaper; identify target-language texts in their own environment, such as on product packaging and store signs or in community newspapers; conduct research to identify significant landmarks in various countries or regions where the target language is spoken, and describe them to the class*)

Teacher prompt: “What kinds of target-language texts can you find in your own community? What do they tell you about the concerns and interests of the people who use the target language?”

C3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions:

identify, in level-appropriate texts in the target language, examples of sociolinguistic conventions associated with a variety of social situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken (*e.g., classify salutations used in letters, e-mails, and postcards according to the context; distinguish between formal and informal expressions used in e-mails; skim a variety of texts to identify vocabulary related to extending invitations; identify words and expressions unique to a particular region in a text they have read in class; interpret abbreviations commonly used in social networking or text messages in the target language*)

Teacher prompts: “Look at the forms of address in a letter to a friend and a letter to a government official. How do they differ, and what is the effect of each on the reader?” “What expressions can you use to extend an invitation?”

D. WRITING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Purpose, Audience, and Form:** write texts in the target language for different purposes and audiences, using a variety of forms and knowledge of language structures and conventions of the written language appropriate for this course;
- D2. The Writing Process:** use the stages of the writing process – including pre-writing, producing drafts, revising, editing, and publishing – to develop and organize content, clarify ideas and expression, correct errors, and present their written work in the target language effectively;
- D3. Intercultural Understanding:** in their written work in the target language, demonstrate an awareness of aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of the appropriate use of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language in a variety of situations.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Purpose, Audience, and Form

By the end of this course, students will:

D1.1 Identifying Purpose and Audience:

determine, with support from the teacher, their purpose for writing and the audience for texts in the target language they plan to create (*e.g., to describe favourite activities to a pen pal by letter; to convey best wishes to a friend in a card or note; to compose an e-mail inviting friends to a party; to compile a to-do list itemizing tasks for a small-group project; to produce a brief weather report for a school news broadcast; to create a chart to track weekly spending*)

Teacher prompt: “What text form best suits your purpose? What are its organizational elements?”

D1.2 Writing in a Variety of Forms: write a variety of level-appropriate texts in the target language, applying their knowledge of the basic structural and stylistic elements of each form (*e.g., captions for photographs of a class activity; a brief e-mail to a peer asking for information about a homework task; a greeting card suited to an occasion; a chart tracking the date, time, and type of class activities over a month; a poster containing a list of items that can be recycled or listing ways to reduce waste and energy used in school or at home; a spreadsheet to document spending as the basis for an annual budget or financial plan*)

Teacher prompts: “Which elements of an e-mail differ from those of a greeting card?” “What elements of a chart help you organize your information?”

D1.3 Applying Language Knowledge: use language structures and conventions appropriate for this course (see the Language Knowledge chart for international languages in Appendix B) to communicate their intended meaning in written work in the target language

D2. The Writing Process

By the end of this course, students will:

D2.1 Generating, Developing, and Organizing Content: generate, develop, and organize ideas for writing in the target language, using some pre-writing strategies and resources, during modelled, shared, guided, and independent writing activities (*e.g., with a peer, brainstorm ideas for writing topics using visual prompts; in a small group, use collaborative graphic organizers to generate possible topics; refer to modelled and shared reading activities to find ideas for writing, and record them by sketching or noting key words; use peer and teacher feedback to help them determine which points to include and which to leave out of a procedural text; use a graphic organizer to sort information and ideas into categories before creating an outline*)

Teacher prompts: “What ideas did you find interesting in your reading activities? How could you explore one of the topics in your own writing?” “What are some key words related to your topic?” “What kind of organizer helps you sort your ideas for a writing task?”

D2.2 Drafting and Revising: plan and produce drafts in the target language following a model, and revise their writing using a variety of strategies, with teacher support (e.g., *use teacher-prepared sentence starters to help them plan a rough draft; consult models to ensure they have used correct word order and sentence structure; read pamphlets, advertisements, and other authentic texts to find relevant vocabulary; refer to a teacher-prepared template to ensure that they cover key points in their draft; refer to teacher and peer feedback to help them rewrite or revise a draft; while writing a draft, consult resources such as a class word wall, a personal lexicon, and/or a dictionary to confirm spelling and enrich their vocabulary; reread their draft to identify gaps in the information presented*)

Teacher prompts: “What words or expressions did you find in this pamphlet that are relevant to your topic? How can you use them in your draft?” “As you review your draft, do you notice any gaps in the information? Is it missing or just in the wrong place? If you reorder the points, will it solve the problem?”

D2.3 Producing Finished Work: make improvements to enhance the clarity and readability of their written work in the target language, and use some elements of effective presentation to produce a polished product for publication (e.g., *use font size and/or style to distinguish headings and text; highlight key information by putting it in textboxes; add high-frequency adjectives to make the message more precise; add photo captions*)

Teacher prompts: “What typographic features are useful to emphasize important ideas?” “What graphic elements could you use to support your key ideas?”

D2.4 Metacognition:

- (a) describe some strategies they found helpful before, during, and after writing;
- (b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as writers, and plan steps they can take to improve their writing skills (e.g., *keep a portfolio of strategies that were helpful during the writing process; plan to use peer and teacher feedback to help them determine next steps to improve their writing; plan to use a graphic organizer before writing to identify the most*

logical sequence for their ideas; identify the place where they prefer to write and describe its appeal)

Teacher prompts: “What aspects of the peer feedback you received were particularly helpful? How will you incorporate them in your next writing task?” “Where do you find it easiest to concentrate while writing? What are the key characteristics of that space, such as good lighting or quiet music? If you have to write in another place, how could you try to duplicate those characteristics?”

D3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

D3.1 Intercultural Awareness: in their written work in the target language, communicate information about communities where the target language is spoken, including aspects of their cultures and their contributions to the world, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (e.g., *on an outline map, label the countries and regions where the target language is spoken; on a postcard to a friend, include an interesting fact about a target-language community; compare the currencies or writing systems in Canada with those in another country where the target language is spoken, using a T-chart; compose an acrostic or a concrete poem explaining the origins and meaning of target-language names; write an e-mail to a target-language speaker describing what they have learned about his or her community; create a poster providing information about a holiday, festival, or tradition in a target-language community*)

Teacher prompts: “What do you know about the history of this community? What do you know about its traditions, typical recreation, or cuisine? Make sure that your e-mail includes various kinds of information.” “What facts about this holiday can you include on your poster to promote interest in it?”

D3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions:

identify sociolinguistic conventions associated with a variety of social situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken, and use them appropriately in their written work in the target language (e.g., *introduce themselves to a pen pal using conventional expressions; use the appropriate level of formality in an application for a volunteer position in a target-language community; use target-language date, number, and currency formats correctly in a weekly log of personal spending; employ a salutation, an*

expression of courtesy, and a conventional closing in a thank-you note; write a short note to a friend or the school principal, adjusting the level of formality accordingly)

Teacher prompts: “Are the conventional ways to represent the date, numbers, and money in the target language similar to or different from those you usually use? Give an example.”
“What examples can you give of familiar or informal words and expressions that are appropriate to use when writing to a friend?”
“How are you going to close your message?”